CDCT REQUIRES YOU TO LEARN A NEW TESTING FRAMEWORK (PACT)

PDCT offers a simplified workflow and—unlike CDCT—it doesn't require you and your teams to learn a new testing framework. PactFlow has introduced the concept of adapters (https://mng.bz/JNq0), which allows you to generate contracts from existing tools.

To expand, if you and your teams are already using existing testing tools and you want to use these tools for contract testing, PDCT supports the bring your own (BYO) tools concept. From a provider perspective, providers can use their existing API tests or OpenAPI specification, rather than introduce new contract tests and Pact verification tasks into their pipeline. On the other hand, from a consumer perspective, consumers can use existing test frameworks that they already have in place and generate contracts as a by-product of these tests.

PactFlow has numerous adapters for both consumers and providers. Popular consumer adapters that are supported include Cypress, Mock Service Worker (MSW), mountebank, Nock, Playwright, and WireMock. On the other side, popular provider adapters that are supported include Postman, Dredd, REST Assured, ReadyAPI, and SoapUI. Because there are a lot of adapters, we're only going to cover how to get started with PDCT using Cypress and WireMock for the consumer adapter. For the provider adapters, we'll cover Postman and Dredd. To get the most up-to-date list of adapters, always refer to the PactFlow's documentation site (https://docs.pactflow.io/docs/examples). You can also create custom adapters for your specific tooling (https://mng.bz/w5aq).

CDCT ISN'T SUITED FOR THIRD-PARTY APIS OR PUBLIC APIS

Because CDCT requires a lot of communication and coordination between consumers and data providers, it could be challenging to implement if there are third-party or public APIs. PDCT addresses this drawback by not requiring the same level of coordination.